

Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

STANDING FOR GREEN WARRIORS

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Four Families, and a Widening Circle — August 2026 in Review

August began with the releases the Trust had promised and ended with its circle wider than before. On August 1, ₹2.00 lakh reached the family of Late Shri Vikaskumar N. Desai, Forest Range Officer (FRO), Gujarat, and first instalment of ₹1.50 lakh to the family of Late Shri Lakhan Singh Maravi, Fire Watcher, Madhya Pradesh (MP). Then, within three days of each other, two more frontline personnel made the supreme sacrifice—a Forest Guard (FG) killed by a sloth bear in the Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve, Maharashtra, on August 9, and a Forest Beat Officer (FG) electrocuted in Telangana on August 11 by a live wire laid by poachers. In both cases the first instalment reached the family within days of the incident. In all, ₹5.50 lakh reached four families during the month, taking the Trust's assistance since its revival in January to ten families and ₹19.35 lakh. The Governing Body (GB) met for the ninth time, the Trust secured its NGO-DARPAN registration, and its message travelled — to the IFS officers of Skills Upgradation Course and IFS probationers at IGNFA, Dehradun, and to the PCCF (HoFF), Odisha.

◆ ASSISTANCE EXTENDED — TWO MORE SUPREME SACRIFICES



Late Shri Shyamu M. Sharnagat
Forest Guard, Navegaon-Nagzira TR

Late Shri Shyamu Mahagu Sharnagat, FG, Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve, Maharashtra

Shri Shyamu Mahagu Sharnagat, FG, Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve, Gondia, Maharashtra, was attacked and killed by a sloth bear on August 9, 2026 while on patrol duty. The GB, through circulation on August 10, approved financial assistance of ₹2.00 lakh to the family, and a first instalment of ₹1.00 lakh was released on August 12, 2026 — the third day after the incident. The balance instalment will follow as resources permit.



Late Shri B Naveen
Forest Beat Officer, Palvancha Range

Late Shri B Naveen, FG, Bhadradi Kothagudem District, Telangana

Shri Naveen, FG, Palvancha Range, Bhadradi Kothagudem District, Telangana, made the supreme sacrifice on the night of August 11, 2026 — electrocuted while attempting to apprehend poachers who had laid a live wire for wild boar at a plantation site. He is survived by his wife, a daughter aged six years and a son aged two. The Trust approved financial assistance of ₹2.00 lakh, and a first instalment of ₹1.00 lakh was credited to the account of his spouse on August 25, 2026; the balance will be released as resources permit.

◆ NINTH MEETING OF THE GOVERNING BODY — AUGUST 14, 2026

The GB held its ninth meeting on August 14, 2026 through virtual mode. The main decisions were as follows.

- ▶ The financial assistance approved through circulation was ratified — for the families of Late Shri Vikaskumar N. Desai (Gujarat), Late Shri Lakhan Singh Maravi (MP) and Late Shri Shyamu Mahagu Sharnagat (Maharashtra).
- ▶ Henceforth, every electronic transfer of financial assistance will be accompanied by an official letter from the Trust conveying its condolences and solidarity. Since assistance moves online rather than by cheque, the letter—with copies to the PCCF (HoFF) and the DCF concerned — will be delivered personally to the family by local forest staff, and a photograph of the handover shared, so that every family knows the fraternity stands behind the transfer.
- ▶ Reaffirming its core objective, the GB resolved that immediate financial assistance to affected personnel will continue irrespective of whether the State Government concerned has a compensatory policy in place.
- ▶ Shri C D Singh, Member (GB), was appointed the Trust's central coordinator, to liaise with the PCCF (HoFF) and the DCF concerned in collecting and verifying particulars in all pending and new cases.
- ▶ Formal communications will be addressed to the Chief Ministers of States presently lacking dedicated welfare policies for forest personnel, urging frameworks for ex-gratia compensation and compassionate appointment on the lines of those implemented by Maharashtra, Madhya Pradesh and Karnataka.

The meeting also adopted the recommendations of the brainstorming session held on August 4, 2026 on sustaining and expanding the Trust's activities. Among the decisions:

- ▶ a recurring-donation mechanism — bank standing instructions, e-mandates and card authorisations — to be instituted by donors;
- ▶ official receipts to be issued for all donations, irrespective of amount;
- ▶ a cadre-wise list of donors to be published on the Trust's website;
- ▶ the MoEFCC, as the nodal Ministry, to be requested to contribute to the Trust;
- ▶ online briefings to be arranged with the Ministry's training institutes and academies, so that officers attending MCT and other courses can be apprised; and
- ▶ a State-level unit of the Trust to be piloted in Uttarakhand before replication elsewhere.

◆ TAKING THE MESSAGE OUTWARD

IGNFA, Dehradun—August 17, 2026. The President visited the Indira Gandhi National Forest Academy and addressed the officers attending the Skills Upgradation Course and the IFS probationers of the 2025 batch — on why the Trust was revived, what it has done in its first seven months, and what the senior members already working in SFDs for long time and youngest members of the Service can do to carry it forward.



IGNFA interaction — August 17, 2026

Briefing the Central Empowered Committee (CEC). The President and Shri A. K. Johri, Member (GB), briefed the Hon'ble Chairman, CEC, on the objectives and activities of the Trust, requesting that representatives of the SFDs and the Hon'ble Supreme Court be apprised of its work.

PCCF (HoFF), Odisha — August 30, 2026. Pursuant to the decision of the GB, an online meeting was held with the PCCF (HoFF), Odisha. The Trust's objectives and assistance record were presented, along with the ways in which the State's field formations can partner with the Trust — in verifying case particulars promptly and in spreading word among staff. Similar meetings with PCCF (HoFF) of other States/UTs follow in September and subsequently.

◆ HOMAGE

Shri Vinod Rishi, IFS (WB:1969) • July 29, 2026

A doyen of India's wildlife conservation movement, Shri Vinod Rishi passed away on July 29, 2026. The Trust conveyed its condolences to Mrs. Romeen Rishi on August 1, 2026.

Dr. Srishti Pal Vasudeva, IFS (HP:1982) • August 17, 2026

Dr. Vasudeva, who headed the Forest Force of Himachal Pradesh as PCCF passed away on August 17, 2026. The Trust conveyed its condolences to the family on August 20, 2026.

◆ TRUST CORPUS — AS ON AUGUST 31, 2026

464 Donors since revival	₹23.44 L Received since revival	₹19.35 L Disbursed — ten cases
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August brought 44 contributions aggregating ₹3,04,601 — taking the total received since the revival of the Trust in January 2026 to ₹23,44,178 from 464 donors. Against this, ₹19.35 lakh stands disbursed across ten cases — one Fire Watcher, six FGs, one Forester, one FRO and one ACF, grievously injured or fallen in the line of duty. Total assistance approved in the ten cases is ₹22.85 lakh.

Beneficiary	Particulars	Assistance	Disbursed
Shri Jitendra Singh Shekhawat	FG, Dholpur, Rajasthan — killed confronting illegal sand mining	₹1.35 L	Feb 11, 2026
Shri Harikesh Singh Gurjar	FG, Morena Division, Madhya Pradesh — killed on duty against illegal sand mining	₹3.00 L	May 12, 2026
Thiru S. Radhakrishnan	ACF, Tamil Nadu Forest Academy, Coimbatore — grievously injured on duty	₹2.00 L	May 30, 2026
Ms. Rasmita Subuddhi	FG, Malkangiri Division, Odisha — emergency medical treatment after patrol-duty accident	₹2.50 L	Jun 15, 2026
Late Shri Sohan Singh	FG, Tons Division, Uttarakhand — died battling a forest fire	₹2.00 L	Jun 22, 2026
Late Shri Hari Om	Forester, Mahendergarh Division, Haryana — died in a road accident on duty travel	₹3.00 L	Jul 28, 2026
Late Shri Vikaskumar N. Desai	FRO, Vyara Division, Gujarat — killed intercepting illegal transport of khair wood	₹2.00 L	Aug 1, 2026
Late Shri Lakhan Singh Maravi	Fire Watcher, Kanha Tiger Reserve, Madhya Pradesh — killed in a tiger attack on morning patrol	₹1.50 L*	Aug 1, 2026
Late Shri Shyamu M. Sharnagat	FG, Navegaon-Nagzira Tiger Reserve, Maharashtra — killed by a sloth bear on patrol	₹1.00 L*	Aug 12, 2026
Late Shri B Naveen	FG, Bhadradi Kothagudem, Telangana — electrocuted while apprehending poachers	₹1.00 L*	Aug 25, 2026

* First instalments. Assistance approved: ₹3.00 lakh (Madhya Pradesh), ₹2.00 lakh (Maharashtra) and ₹2.00 lakh (Telangana); balance installments aggregating ₹3.50 lakh will be released as resources permit.

◆ IFSBWT “SANKALP 10K” — A CALL TO OUR FRATERNITY

On August 30, 2026, a message from Ms. Jyotsna Sitling, a Trustee, went out to IFS groups across the country: in the three most recent cases the Trust could release only first instalment for want of funds, and what it lacks is not goodwill but predictability. Responding to the GB's call for regular contributions, eleven colleagues have

already pledged a fixed monthly sum for three years. Encouraged by these pioneers, the Trust has launched **IFSBWT “SANKALP 10K”**: a call to 10,000 serving and retired IFS and SFS officers to pledge a small amount, howsoever modest, on a regular basis, and the IFS Association has been requested to carry the campaign to every member.

A contribution, however small, given regularly, is what builds a corpus.

◆ THE HARYANA EXPERIENCE — A STORY WORTH REPEATING

In April this year, at the request of Shri R. K. Sapra, Shri R. Anand, CF, Haryana, spoke to the field staff of his Circle about the Trust — through his DFOs, S/Shri Satish, Rohtash, Rajesh Vats, Pavan, Rajesh Leelar and Satish Kumar.

No circular. No target. No collection list.

Over the next few days, **187 contributions** reached the Trust from that establishment — FGs, Foresters, Dy. ROs, FROs, clerks and Group ‘D’ staff, besides ACFs and DCFs. Amounts from ₹500 to ₹15,000. Together, more than **₹1.8 lakh**.

These are the very people the Trust exists to protect. On modest salaries, in remote beats, they know better than anyone what happens to a family when a Forest Guard does not come home. They did not wait to be asked twice. The GB placed its appreciation on record.

We are not asking any State to match a figure. We are asking for one conversation — at your Circle, your Division, your next staff meeting. Explain what the Trust does. Then let each person decide, freely. That is all Haryana did.

◆ MILESTONES — AUGUST 2026

August 1, 2026	₹2.00 lakh released to the family of Late Shri Vikaskumar N. Desai (Gujarat) and a first instalment of ₹1.50 lakh to the family of Late Shri Lakhan Singh Maravi (Madhya Pradesh). Condolence message conveyed on the passing of Shri Vinod Rishi.
August 4, 2026	Brainstorming session on sustaining and expanding the Trust’s activities; recommendations placed before the GB.
August 10–12, 2026	Assistance of ₹2.00 lakh approved in the Navegaon-Nagzira (Maharashtra) case; first instalment of ₹1.00 lakh released on August 12 — the third day after the incident.
August 14, 2026	Ninth meeting of the GB (virtual). Circulation approvals ratified; brainstorming recommendations adopted; Shri C. D. Singh was appointed central coordinator for case verification.
August 17, 2026	The President addresses the officers of the Skills Upgradation Course and IFS probationers (2025 batch) at IGNFA, Dehradun.
August 25, 2026	First instalment of ₹1.00 lakh released in the Telangana case.
August 27, 2026	Trust registered on the NITI Aayog NGO-DARPAN portal — Unique ID DL/2026/1100169.
August 30, 2026	Online meeting with the PCCF (HoFF), Odisha, on the Trust’s objectives and activities.

◆ ON THE HORIZON — SEPTEMBER 2026

- ▶ National Forest Martyrs’ Day, September 11 — the Trust joins the fraternity in honouring the memory of all who have fallen in the protection of India’s forests and wildlife.
- ▶ Release of the balance instalments — aggregating ₹3.50 lakh — in the Madhya Pradesh, Maharashtra and Telangana cases, as resources permit.
- ▶ Online meetings with PCCFs (HoFFs) of other States/UTs; briefing of the ADG (FC) and the heads of MoEFCC Regional Offices.
- ▶ Virtual meeting with State Coordinators and Nodal Officers.
- ▶ Comments on the draft Guidelines for Scrutiny and Evaluation of Proposals on the suggestions of the Committee to be received and the Guidelines finalised for adoption.
- ▶ Letters to the Chief Ministers of States lacking dedicated welfare policies for forest personnel.

- ▶ Activation of the SBI payment gateway on www.foresttrust.in.
- ▶ Audit of accounts and filing of the income-tax return for FY 2025–26.

◆ SUPPORT THE CAUSE

Contribute to the Trust Corpus

UPI ID: ifsbwt@sbi **Account No.:** 30454625682

Account Name: Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

Bank & Branch: State Bank of India, CGO Complex, Lodi Road, New Delhi – 110003

IFSC: SBIN0007837 **PAN:** AACTI5925J

NGO-DARPAN ID: DL/2026/1100169

Payments accepted via UPI · BHIM · Net Banking · Google Pay · PhonePe · Paytm

- Earmarked donations for specific cases are transferred in full to the named beneficiary family. The Trust acts as a facilitating agency and retains nothing.



Indian Forest Service Benevolent and Welfare Trust

Dedicated to the welfare of all forestry field personnel and their families

Frontline Field Staff · Forest Range Officers · State Forest Service Officers · Indian Forest Service Officers